

Word family: **wallet / wallets**

Base word: wallet

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **leather wallet**

* **wallet with cards/cash**

* **digital wallet**

* **mobile wallet**

* **crypto wallet**

* **wallet app**

* **wallet-sized**

* **open your wallet**

* **vote with your wallet**

Meaning in this passage

> In the past, I had given people fairly standard gifts, like books, chocolates, **wallets**, or gift cards.

Here, **wallets** means:

small folding cases used to carry money, bank cards, identification, etc. — 銀包；錢包

中文翻譯：

以前我送人的，多半都是一些很常規的禮物，例如書、朱古力、**銀包**或者禮品卡。

So here:

wallet = 用來放現金、銀行卡、身份證等隨身物品的小型錢包

1. **wallet (銀包；錢包) — 銀包；錢包**

This is the core meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original context

> I had given people gifts like books, chocolates, and **wallets**.

我以前送過書、朱古力和**銀包**等禮物。

Practice 2

> He took his **wallet** out of his pocket.

他從口袋裏拿出**銀包**。

Practice 3

> I left my **wallet** at home.

我把**銀包**留在家裏了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wallet = a small case used to carry money, cards, identification, and similar personal items****

中文：

****用來攜帶現金、卡片、證件等物品的小型隨身錢包****

2. ****leather wallet — 皮銀包****

Practice 1

> She bought him a ****leather wallet**** for his birthday.

她生日送了他一個****皮銀包****。

Practice 2

> The ****leather wallet**** lasted for years.

那個****皮銀包****用了很多年。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leather wallet = a wallet made mainly from leather****

3. ****wallet containing cash/cards — 放現金 / 卡的銀包****

Practice 1

> My **wallet** contains several bank cards.

我的**銀包**裏有幾張銀行卡。

Practice 2

> He opened his **wallet** and took out some cash.

他打開**銀包**，拿出一些現金。

MCQ-ready definition:

wallet = a personal holder for money and cards

4. **digital wallet — 數碼錢包；電子錢包**

A major modern extension.

Practice 1

> I added my bank card to my **digital wallet**.

我把銀行卡加入了**數碼錢包**。

Practice 2

> You can pay using a **digital wallet** on your phone.

你可以用手機上的**電子錢包**付款。

MCQ-ready definition:

digital wallet = software that securely stores payment information or digital credentials

中文：

用來儲存付款資料、卡片資料或數碼憑證的電子系統

5. **mobile wallet — 手機錢包；流動支付錢包**

Practice 1

> She paid through her **mobile wallet**.

她用**手機錢包**付款。

Practice 2

> Many people now use **mobile wallets** instead of physical cards.

現在很多人使用**手機錢包**，而不是實體卡。

MCQ-ready definition:

mobile wallet = a digital wallet used through a smartphone or mobile device

6. **wallet app — 錢包應用程式**

Practice 1

> Open the **wallet app** to show your boarding pass.

打開**錢包應用程式**顯示登機證。

Practice 2

> The ticket is stored in my **wallet app**.

車票 / 門票儲存在我的**錢包 App** 裏。

MCQ-ready definition:

wallet app = an application used to store payment cards, tickets, passes, or other digital credentials

7. **crypto wallet — 加密貨幣錢包**

A distinct technical sense.

Practice 1

> He moved the assets to a private **crypto wallet**.

他把資產轉移到私人**加密貨幣錢包**。

Practice 2

> A **crypto wallet** stores the credentials needed to access cryptocurrency.

****加密貨幣錢包**儲存存取加密資產所需的憑證。**

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crypto wallet = software or hardware used to manage the cryptographic keys needed to access cryptocurrency****

中文：

****用來管理存取加密貨幣所需密鑰的軟件或硬件工具****

8. **wallet (比喻：個人財力 / 消費能力) — 荷包；財力**

A common figurative extension.

Practice 1

> Rising prices are hurting consumers' ****wallets****.

物價上升正在打擊消費者的****荷包****。

Practice 2

> The new fees will hit people's ****wallets**** hard.

新的收費會令市民的****荷包大受影響****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wallet = figuratively, a person's available money or spending power****

中文：

****比喻某人的可用金錢、消費能力或荷包****

9. **open your wallet — 掏錢；願意花錢**

Practice 1

> Fans were willing to ****open their wallets**** for the new product.

粉絲願意為新產品****掏錢****。

Practice 2

> The charity campaign encouraged people to ****open their wallets****.

慈善活動鼓勵大家****慷慨解囊****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****open your wallet = informal: spend or donate money****

中文：

****非正式：願意花錢或捐錢****

10. ****vote with your wallet — 用消費選擇表態****

A useful figurative expression.

Practice 1

> Consumers can ****vote with their wallets**** by choosing different brands.

消費者可以透過選擇不同品牌來****用消費表態****。

Practice 2

> People ****voted with their wallets**** and stopped buying the product.

人們****以購買選擇表達立場****，停止購買該產品。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****vote with your wallet = show approval or disapproval through what you choose to buy or financially support****

中文：

****透過購買、拒買或金錢支持來表達取態****

11. ****wallet-sized — 銀包大小的；可放入銀包的****

Practice 1

> Please bring a ****wallet-sized photo****.

請帶一張**銀包大小的照片**。

Practice 2

> The card is **wallet-sized**.

這張卡的尺寸**可以放入銀包**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wallet-sized = small enough or designed to fit inside a wallet****

12. **wallet (digital identity/pass holder) — 數碼證件 / 票券儲存工具**

This overlaps with **digital wallet**, but the function is broader than payment.

Practice 1

> My boarding pass is saved in my phone's **wallet**.

我的登機證儲存在手機的**錢包程式**裏。

Practice 2

> The **wallet** stores tickets, passes, and identification cards.

這個**數碼錢包**可儲存門票、通行證和身份卡。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wallet = a digital storage system for payment cards, tickets, passes, or identity credentials****

Important distinction 1: **wallet vs purse**

This is especially important across varieties of English.

wallet

usually a small folding holder for:

- * money
- * cards
- * ID

purse

varies by dialect:

* in **BrE**, often a small container for coins/money

* in **AmE**, often means a handbag

So **wallet = 銀包** is generally the safest translation here.

Important distinction 2: **wallet vs handbag**

wallet

small; normally fits inside a pocket or bag.

handbag

larger bag carried by hand/shoulder.

A handbag may contain a wallet.

Important distinction 3: **wallet vs card holder**

wallet

usually holds multiple types of items:

* cash

* cards

* ID

card holder

mainly holds cards and is often slimmer.

Important distinction 4: **wallet vs money clip**

wallet

encloses/stores money and cards.

money clip

holds folded notes using a clip.

They serve similar purposes but are structurally different.

Important distinction 5: **physical wallet vs digital wallet**

Physical

> I left my wallet at home.

我把銀包留在家。

Digital

> Add the card to your digital wallet.

把卡加入電子錢包。

The second is metaphorical: it performs a similar storage/payment function digitally.

Important distinction 6: **digital wallet vs bank account**

digital wallet

stores credentials/value/access methods for payment.

bank account

holds money within a banking institution.

A wallet may connect to a bank account, but they are not the same thing.

Important distinction 7: **crypto wallet does not literally store coins**

A useful technical clarification:

A **crypto wallet** typically manages the cryptographic keys/credentials that allow access to blockchain assets.

So the metaphorical “wallet” is about **access and control**, not physical storage.

Important distinction 8: **wallet = object vs wallet = money**

Literal

> I lost my wallet.

我不見了銀包。

Figurative

> The price increase hurts my wallet.

加價傷荷包。

The figurative use means **finances**, not the physical object.

Important distinction 9: **open your wallet vs open a wallet**

Literal

> Open your wallet and take out the card.

打開銀包拿出卡。

Figurative

> People opened their wallets for charity.

大家慷慨捐款。

Context decides whether **open** is physical or metaphorical.

Important distinction 10: **vote with your wallet vs vote**

Vote with your wallet does not refer to an actual ballot.

It means:

make an economic choice that expresses support or rejection

So spending becomes metaphorically similar to voting.

Family-extension note

Wallet has one very strong physical core and several modern metaphorical extensions:

1. **physical money/card holder**

- * wallet
- * leather wallet
- * wallet-sized

2. **digital equivalent**

- * digital wallet
- * mobile wallet
- * wallet app

3. **crypto access tool**

- * crypto wallet

4. **personal finances**

- * hurt someone's wallet
- * open your wallet

5. **economic choice as expression**

- * vote with your wallet

The semantic link is consistent:

a place or means for holding/accessing financial value

The physical wallet holds cash/cards; the digital wallet holds payment credentials; the figurative wallet represents your spending power.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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wallet	銀包；錢包	money/card holder
leather wallet	皮銀包	material
wallet with cash/cards	放現金 / 卡的銀包	physical storage
digital wallet	數碼 / 電子錢包	electronic payment storage
mobile wallet	手機錢包	phone-based wallet
wallet app	錢包應用程式	digital cards/tickets
crypto wallet	加密貨幣錢包	key-management tool
wallet (figurative)	荷包；財力	spending power
hurt someone's wallet	傷荷包	financial cost
open your wallet	掏錢；慷慨解囊	spend/donate
vote with your wallet	用消費表態	economic choice
wallet-sized	銀包大小的	small enough to fit

For your original sentence

> In the past, I had given people fairly standard gifts, like books, chocolates, **wallets**, or gift cards.

Here:

wallets = 用來放現金、銀行卡和證件的實體銀包

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 以前我送人的，多半都是一些很常規的禮物，例如書、朱古力、**銀包**或者禮品卡。

For this passage, it is the straightforward **physical wallet** sense, contrasted with the much more personal handmade photo album.